

Nettop galore!

Airtel launched a net PC featuring a 15-inch LCD, keyboard, mouse and cloud-based storage of 10 GB. Airtel internet packages range from Rs. 699 to Rs. 1,199 per month

Android OS 2.0

Android OS 2.0 with added multimedia support and new features will soon be seen on Sony Ericsson phones.

Bazaar

ATI Radeon HD 4770

The budget performer

Here's the latest from the AMD labs - The ATI Radeon HD 4770, which has the world's first 40-nm GPU, codenamed the RV740.

With a 40-nm GPU, the card works out more economical for AMD to manufacture. The PCB of this card is an inch shorter than the HD 4850, but due to ATI's cooling solution for this card, it still takes up two I/O slots.

We used an Intel QX9650 GHz and 4 GB of DDR2 memory at 1066 MHz. We tested the games at these resolutions: 1600 x 1200 and 1920 x 1440, with 4x AA and 4x AF, out of these *Crysis* gave us the lowest scores - 14 and 11 fps (as expected). We also tested *Doom 3*, which gave us fps almost touching 150 fps,

Prey giving us about 75 fps at the higher settings, *Unreal Tournament III* gave us 42 fps at the higher settings. *F.E.A.R.* barely went over 62 fps whereas *Company of Heroes* gave us 104.8 fps on the higher settings. These results clearly show that even though this card will not give you the best performance at higher resolutions for all games, it will give decent results at resolutions up to 1280 x 1024.

Not everybody is after building the world's fastest PC, but there are people who still want to just upgrade their rigs without actually spending too much. For people looking to buy a graphics card with a budget of not more than Rs. 8,000, this is the card to go for.



Contact

AMD India

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Web site: www.amd.com

Price: Rs. 7,999

Specifications

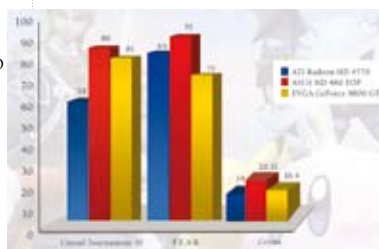
Stream Processors: 640

Core Clock: 750 MHz

Memory Clock: 800 MHz

Memory Size: 512 MB

Memory Interface: 128-bit GDDR5



RATINGS

Features7
Performance7.5
Build Quality7.5
Value for money8
Overall7.5

Gigabyte EG45M-UD2H

Small but pricey

The layout of the EG45M-UD2H is such that it fits all the necessary elements within its mATX form factor. There's only a single PCIe slot, so no SLI.

The expansion slots include a PCIe x1, PCIe x16 and two PCI slots. This board has the usual connects such as USB, e-SATA and FireWire, but also offers VGA, DVI as well as HDMI-outs. The HDMI-out comes in really handy if you have a big LCD TV you want to hook up to your computer.

We tested the performance of this board with an Intel QX9650 3.0 GHz, 4 GB of DDR2 memory and used the integrated graphics, which in this case is the Intel Media Graphic Accelerator X4500 HD. We compared this motherboard to the MSI P7NGM Digital which was the best performer of our last motherboard

comparison test with integrated graphics.

The EGM45-UD2H is not one of the best performing motherboards. Priced at Rs. 9,900 this motherboard is just too expensive to be an mATX HTPC, and is also too expensive to be a regular system. The ZOTAC and MSI motherboards we compared this board to, make a better buy as they are priced also much lower at around Rs. 6,000.

	Gigabyte EG45M-UD2H	MSI P7NGM Digital
PC Mark 05	7477	5802
3D Mark 05	2185	2684
Video Encoding - 100MB (sec)	69.9	68
Doom 3 (640x480 / 1024x768)	32.5 / 24	56.2 / 32.4
CoH (800x600 / 1280x1024)	26.9 / 16.9	19.5 / 13.1



Contact

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Web site: www.gigabyte.in

Price: Rs. 9,900

Specifications

Northbridge: Intel G45

Southbridge: Intel ICH10R

Intel Graphics Media Accelerator X4500HD

ALC889A HD Audio

RATINGS

Features7.5
Performance7
Build Quality7
Value for money6
Overall7